How to: book hours

Friday already?! Time to book your hours!

Do you book that meet-up on the customer, or on an internal project? And what about the time you spent helping a colleague, the training you followed and that holiday? This document helps you to determine which hours you do, and which hours you don't book on the customer.

Good to know:

- **We book our hours at Digital Power in order to determine which hours we can bill the customer for.** You should not see it as a way we keep tabs on what you do in a week exactly. We trust that you use your hours as effectively as possible.
- **We look at the output*, rather than the actual hours spent.** Have you, for example, attended two internal meetings this week, and also completed the expected work for the customer? Book all of the hours that were contractually agreed upon with the customer.

**output = hours x (motivation + speed + quality). Did you deliver quality work, fast? That means your customer is very happy with you and we can bill them as was agreed. You, in the mean time, have time to do something extra: a win-win-win!*

To book, or not to book on a client

Do you have (an) assignment(s) that cover the entirety of your contract hours?

- **?** → **Example 1:** You have a contract for 40 hours/week. You are on an assignment for 32 hours/week. That means you are not 100% billable, for you are not spending all of your contractual hours on billable work.

  Example 1: You have a contract for 40 hours/week. You have one assignment for 16 hours/week, and another for 24 hours/week. That is a total of 40 hours/week and that makes you 100% billable. Your assignments cover the entirety of your contractual hours.
- **Yes** → Does it concern a CDS / Service Contract?
  - **Yes** → These contracts are deliberately designed to be billed for actual hours. This means you only get to bill hours on the customer you have actually worked. Do not be too courtial or modest when deciding the amount of hours that are to be billed, though. Consult with the responsible Business Manager or Robin if you would like to know which hours you can bill on the customer
  - **No** → You book all of the sold / contractually agreed upon hours on the customer. Because of the many activities and possibilities to work on your development within Digital Power and the opportunities to contribute to the development of the organization, there are a number of exception to this rule
    - Multiple customers in one week? And hours that you should book on internal projects, according to the information in the categories below? Divide these hours over these customers at your own discretion.
    - These exceptions are divided into the following three categories
- **See also** → Other than your planned customer hours, you have a couple of hours to spend on things that aren't customer related. The majority of these hours are typically spent on study or internal projects. If these hours do not coincide with customer hours, you book them on an internal project code, according to the established structure.

  If a holiday, furlough day, training or something similar coincides with a normal customer day, then we deliver on those hours later on in the week/weeks during the time you normally have no customer work.
  - **?** → **Example :** You have a contract for 40 hours/week. You are on an assignment for 32 hours/week. You normally work for this customer on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday. On Wednesday you have no customer. On Friday, you take a day off, meaning you don't work for the customer that day. Maile sure that you catch up on these hours on one of Wednesdays that you have nothing to do. In this example, you could either work from Monday through Thursday in the same week, or every day in the week after.
- **No**

Category 1

Hours as an investment from Digital Power

These hours include the exceptions with an oftentimes high impact* on our billable hours, that are necessary to realize the ambition of Digital Power. They always require a sign-off and will be paid by Digital Power

***high impact on our billable hours is defined as: 4 hours/week or more structurally**

Activity	Description	Book on customer?	Prerequisites for not booking on the customer	Not booking on the customer? Use this project code.
Training or multi-day course	You are following a training or a multi-day course from Digital Power. The Data Engineering retraining program, for example. For single-day trainings: see Activity 'Academy Training / Customer Case'.	Because of their high impact, these hour generally can't be booked on the customer. We will evaluate if part of these hours can still be booked on the client, though.	This requires a training agreement to be made by **Rogier**. It will contain all the agreements regarding the costs and reserved hours for the training or course.	You book the hours you agreed upon with Rogier **in advance** under project code T-Trainingen
Internal Project (Organizational Backlog)	You are responsible for or are taking part in an internal project. Only projects that are on the organizational backlog are officially seen as internal projects. Think for example of our Cookie scanner or the Diversity Project Group.	Depending on the agreed upon amount per week, the impact on the customer is determined. Less than or equal to 4 hours/week will be booked on the customer as much as possible. More than 4 hours can be booked on an internal project in consultation.	The internal project has to have followed all the steps for the organizational backlog. Part of this is the agreement on the amount of hours that will be seen as an investment from Digital Power .	You book the hours **in advance** under the project that was created specifically for this internal project.
Marketing Projects	You are assisting in the development, analysis of the website or it's maintenance. Also, for example, the Buyer Persona's or our internal dashboards. The development of content is Category 2. For an event on behalf of Marketing, see 'Event / Quarterly outing'.	Depending on the agreed upon amount per week, the impact on the customer is determined. Less than or equal to 4 hours/week will be booked on the customer as much as possible. More than 4 hours can be booked on an internal project in consultation.	**Marloes** has signed off on the hours.	You book the hours on M-Marketing or the project that was created specifically for this purpose. You can book these hours in advance in consultation
Digital Power Datahub Project	You are working on a project on behalf of our foundation 'the Digital Power Datahub'.	For the Digital Power Datahub, only idle hours are used. Exceptions to this rule are possible with a sign-off from both Mariëlle and Robin.	**Mariëlle and Robin** have signed off on these hours.	You book these hours **in advance** for the project that was created specifically for the Datahub project in question.

Category 2

Hours that should be booked on the customer but can be seen as an investment from Digital Power in consultation

Medium impact* on billable hours

***Medium impact is defined as: a one-time occurance of 4 to 8 hours in a single week**

Activity	Description	Book on customer?	Prerequisites for not booking on the customer	Not booking on the customer? Use this project code.
Event / Quarterly Outing	You take part in an event, are at a fair representing Digital Power or you have an outing (Quarterly Digital Power outing or otherwise) in the customer's time.	Can you deliver on the expected output in this week/period, and follow this training? Book the hours on the customer.	Not possible to book the hours on the customer ? See if you can (**in consultation with the Business Manager**) book part of these hours on the customer and the rest on an internal code.	Event / Fair for Marketing should be booked on M-Marketing. Events for personal and/or professional development should be booked on ZO-(Zelf) ontwikkeling. DiP outings are to be booked on B-Bankzit.
Insufficient work for the customer	There is insufficient work to be done to fill the agreed upon hours in a week for the customer. There is a delay because of external parties (developments), indecisiveness from the customer or something similar.	You book the entirety of the agreed upon hours on the customer. These hours have been reserved for the customer in our planning and can't be changed on short notice. This is outside of our control. The customer retains the right to these hours, stay available for example.	Can't figure out / having difficulties with booking these hours? **First consult with a Business Manager** on how to go about this and if there is additional consultation required with the customer. It may be deemed necessary not to book these hours on the customer.	You book this in accordance with the activity you make these hours for.
Development of content	You work with Marketing on the development of an article, customer case, podcast, video, social media post or anything else marketing related.	Can you deliver on the expected output in this week/period, and perform this activity? Book these hours on the customer. Agree on a feasible deadline with the marketing team to minimize the impact on the work you do for the customer.	Not possible to book these hours on the customer? See if you can (if need be **in consultation with Robin / Business Manager**) book a part of these hours on the customer and the rest on an internal project code.	You book these hours on M-Marketing.
Holiday / Furlough / Absenteeism	These include mandatory holidays like Easter and Ascension day, your own forlough (one day or multiple weeks), sick days, a funeral or when your are moving.	These hours are to be booked on the appropiate internal codes on the days in question.	If a day like this coincides with a regular customer day **and** you have the opportunity to catch up on these hours in the same week / period, do it. This will be done instead of idle hours or internal project hours.	For the holiday/furlough in question, you book the hours on the appropiate internal code, like: Holiday (Feestdag), Furlough (Verlof), Special Leave (Bijzonder Verlof) or Absenteeism (Verzuim). Hours that you catch up on later are to be booked on the customer in their entirety.
Academy Training / Customer Case	You follow a training in the customer's time or take part in a customer case at the office.	Can you deliver on the expected output in this week/period, and follow this training? Book these hours on the customer. Personal and professional development is a part of our service to the customer.	Not possible to book these hours on the customer? High priority customer work takes precedence over following a training, unless it is decided **in consultation with Rogier / Business Management** that the training should come first. careful: this means a crucial deadline!	You can book these hours on T-Training after they've been signed off on.

- **?** → **Example 1 :** A (small) business question, the stakeholder would like to have answered the day of the training is not a crucial deadline to justify missing out on a training. This is expectation management, where you indicate that the set deadline is not possible to meet.

  Example 2: Does something that we goven break down, is there a deadline for a project with high impact? These are situations where work for a customer comes first.
- **Not possible to catch up on these hours later?:** Be critical and creative, the customer reserves the room in his budget in advance, to account for the entirety of the hours that were contractually set. Perhaps you van ask a colleague to perform stand-by services in your absence, or you can ask a colleague of a different seniority level or area of expertise to perform something that is not your strong suit. Discuss these ideas with the responsible Business Manager.

Category 2

Hours that should be booked on the customer, originating from personal development and guidance, amongst others.

These include hours that are generally meetings with a low impact* on the customer hours. They are a part of our service or are sporadically not customer related like, for instance, a job interview.

***low impact is defined as: less than 8 hours/month**

Activity	Description	Book on customer?	Prerequisites for not booking on the customer	Not booking on the customer? Use this project code.
Meet-up, peer group and your own Golden Triangle	Regular participation in a meet-up, peer group and your own Golden Triangle. Would you like to partake in a second meet-up, next to the one for your own area of expertise? Be critical of when you do or do not join, depending on your own meet-up calendar.	These activities belong to the standard development of our consultants and are integrated in our service. These hours are to be booked on the customer.	If you don't know what to do here, consult with Rogier.	Not applicable
Help or be helped by a colleague	Asking or answering a question on Teams. Discuss with a couple of colleagues at the office. Help a colleague with a question.	These activities are part of the standard activities of a consultant and are integrated in our service. Sometimes it costs the customer time and in return the consultant becomes more efficient. Book these hours on the customer.	Do you get the feeling you get a lot of question (on the same subject)? Take action and/or consult with Robin. Are there other colleagues that can answer these questions for example? Is there an opportunity to standardize or automate anything here?	Not applicable
Pre-sales	You join a Business Manager in a sales meeting. You help or provide input for making an offer. You update or write your resumé.	There activites sometimes take multiple hours, but are spread over multiple weeks. On a weekly basis, the impact is low. We book these hours on the customer.	Is this for a lengthy and large pre-sales process? For a large project proposition or a tender for example? In that case a Business Manager can decide to create an internal project on which these hours can be booked separately.	Specifically created project for the sales project in question or tender.
Job interviews	Partaking in job interviews for potential new colleagues.	This takes 1 to 1,5 hours per interview on average and can therefore be booked on the customer.	Are you taking part in multiple interviews in a short timespan? Consult with Robin to see if you can book these hours internally.	You book these hours on R-Recruitment
Attendant at a Golden Triangle	These are not your own Golden Triangles, but those Triangles where you are present as an attendant.	These hours are to be booked on the customer. Don't partake in more Golden Triangles than you can handle while on a fulltime assignment.	Is your output for the client under pressure because of the amount of Golden Triangles and is your role essential for these Triangles? Consult with Rogier.	You book these hours on BEG-Begeleiding
Business Update	(Digital) attendance at the monthly business update. Or watching the recording at a later time.	This hour is to be booked on the customer.	If you are unsure what to do, contact Robin.	Not applicable
Buddy / onboarding	Your are coupled to a new colleague in consultation with Reimer. As a buddy you complete the onboarding checklist.	These activities and tasks are well thought out and prepared so that they cost you the least amount of time as possible. Also, these hours are spread over multiple weeks. You book them on the customer.	Are you unable to deliver upon the expected output for this week/period? Consult with Reimer to see if you can book these hours internally.	You book these hours on BEG-Begeleiding